

Joel Kalala-Tshitundu

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PROFESSIONAL HIGHLIGHTS:

- Proficient in Java, Python, and C++, with hands-on experience developing object-oriented applications and data structures.
- Developed full-stack MERN applications using React.js, Vite, Node.js, Express.js, MongoDB, and REST API integration.
- Completed coursework in software engineering, cybersecurity, and database systems, with emphasis on Agile methodology and version control using GitHub.
- Applied knowledge of algorithms and data structures to optimize code performance in multiple academic and personal project
- Collaborated with diverse teams on academic and capstone projects, enhancing communication and teamwork in fast-paced environments.
- Configured networking environments in Cisco Packet Tracer including IP addressing, DNS, router, and switch configuration.
- Built responsive frontend interfaces, protected routes, and role-based authentication systems using modern web technologies

University of Southern Maine, Portland, ME

Dec 2026

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering

Southern Maine Community College, South Portland, ME

Associate degree Computer Science

Dec 2024

Associate degree Cybersecurity

Dec 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- Programming Languages: Java, Python, JavaScript, MIPS, C/C++, Unix
- Web Technologies: React.js, Vite, Node.js, Express.js, HTML, CSS, MongoDB
- Tools: GitHub, Visual Studio Code, Linux, NetBeans, Cisco Packet Tracer, MARS
- Skills: Object-Oriented Programming, Data Structures, REST APIs, Responsive Design, JWT Authentication

PROJECT + RESEARCH EXPERIENCES

University of Southern Maine, Portland, ME

January 2025 – May 2025

Capstone Project: Animal Shelter Management System

- Built a comprehensive full-stack web application to assist a local shelter in managing animal profiles, volunteer opportunities, and adoption workflows
- Developed a MERN-based shelter management system to manage animal profiles, volunteer requests, and adoption workflows.
- Illustrated and documented the Control Event Flow Diagram to visualize system interactions between user interfaces and the backend
- Built React frontend components and integrated Express.js APIs with MongoDB database management.
- Implemented JWT authentication, role-based access control, and responsive UI using React, Axios, HTML/CSS, and VS Code. Collaborated in a 5-member Agile team using GitHub for version control and project coordination.

Southern Maine Community College, South Portland, ME

April 2024

Capstone Project: Unix Command Shell

- Implemented background process execution and command handling using Linux shell operations in C++.
- Collaborated with team members to develop, test, and debug Unix-based system functionality

Shipping Cost Calculator MIPS Assembly

Nov 2023

- Developed a MIPS assembly program using MARS to calculate shipping costs and process user input.
- Implemented loops, conditional statements, and input validation for cost calculations.

Project - Web Portfolio

Jan 2023

- Developed a responsive portfolio website using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript.
- Improved user interaction and mobile responsiveness through dynamic web design.

Southern Maine Community College, South Portland, ME

Oct 2022

Research Project - Stock Portfolio Management System

- Engineered a Java-based application to track and simulate stock investments
- Applied private methods and arrays/lists to ensure efficient portfolio computations
- Ensured user accuracy with real-time input validation and automated analytics to support better investment decisions
- Research the stock market and analyze data to stay competitive

Social Security Number (SSN) Validation Tool

Jan 2022

Personal Project

- Developed a Java GUI application to validate Social Security Numbers with real-time error handling.
- Applied Object-Oriented Programming principles using NetBeans and Java.

Congolese Community Platform

Full-Stack MERN Community Support Platform

May 2026

- Developed a full-stack MERN web platform to support the Congolese community with housing, food, healthcare, and immigration assistance requests
- Built responsive frontend interfaces using React.js and Vite
- Integrated role-based user authentication and protected routes
- Designed backend APIs using Node.js and Express
- Managed project deployment using GitHub and Vercel
- Created an admin dashboard for request management and community support operations
- Implemented mobile-friendly responsive UI for improved accessibility

WORK EXPERIENCE

Granite Bay Care, Scarborough, ME

February 2020 – Present

Direct Support Professional Manager

- Established trusting relationships with clients to support personal development and independences
- Supervised and scheduled a team of 19 direct support staff to ensure daily client care coverage.
- Assisted clients with daily living activities and individualized support plans.
- Trained new staff on safety procedures, communication, and support strategies.
- Communicated regularly with clients, families and healthcare professionals to coordinate client services.